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От **Ребекки Дарли** <<https://iconology.hypotheses.org/author/rdarley>>

Цифровые ресурсы в области социальных и гуманитарных наук

OpenEdition <<https://openedition.org>> 17.02.2015 <<https://iconology.hypotheses.org/1045>>

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**Медаль императора
Иоанна VIII Палеолога
работы Пизанелло (ок.
1438–1442 гг.), из
собрания Британского
музея, Highlights.**



http://www.britishmuseum.org/explore/highlights/highlight_objects/cm/

Возможность делиться
взглядами и идеями с
коллегами, работающими
в самых разных областях,
— одна из привилегий
работы в группе
Bilderfahrzeuge. Этот пост
продолжает разговор,
начатый в **предыдущей**
публикации <

<http://iconology.hypotheses.org/828>> Ханса-

Кристиана <

<http://iconology.hypotheses.org/team/collaborators/honenes-hans-christian>> . В

[c/cast bronze medal of
_john.aspx>](#)

Медаль императора Иоанна
Палеолога работы Пизанно
1438–1442 гг.), из собрани
Британского музея, Лондон

меня на мысли, с которой я
давно знаком. Они создавались как
произведения искусства и по форме
напоминали монеты. Они также часто
производились в широком
распространении, ничего общего с
монетами, и славянской

эпоху Византизма
это были медали
металлические
отлитые или
памятным и
рисунки, им
некоторые с
Пожалуй, од
известных м
стоит упомя
это медальон
с изображен



<http://iconology.hypotheses.org/file>

императора

Палеолога (1

< <https://www.facebook.com/openedition>

была создана в честь визита

императора в Италию. Более

подробную историю ее создания

можно увидеть [здесь](#) <

http://www.britishmuseum.org/explore/highlights/highlight_objects/cm/c/cast_bronze_medal_of_john.aspx>.

Она стала популярной, а самым известным ее примером является долговечная бронзовая медаль римского императора, запечатлевшая, возможно, мозаики VI века с изображением императора Юстиниана I (годы правления 527–565) в церкви Сан-Витале в Равенне.

[s/2015/02/Justinian.jpg>](#)

Юстиниан I в церкви Сан-Витале, Равенна



< <https://x.com/OpenEditionActu>

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[http://www.nationalgallery.org.uk/paintings/attributed-to-gentile-](http://www.nationalgallery.org.uk/paintings/attributed-to-gentile)

медаль изображена императора, путешествовавшего на запад главным образом для своей осажденной столицы, которая должна была безвозвратно пасть от османских войск Мехмеда II в 1453 году. Изображение Иоанна, останавливающегося у придорожного креста, на реверсе трогательно отражает смещение

bellini-the-sultan-mehmet-ii>

Портрет Мехмеда II работы Беллини, ныне хранящийся в Национальной галерее.

византийской куртуазности и древних имперских традиций на роль придорожного нищего. Пизанелло, однако, также стремится подчеркнуть

экзотическую инаковость этого христианского монарха. Его окладистая борода и роскошный головной убор стали атрибутами «восточного» правителя. Действительно, это очень напоминает лекцию профессора Виктора Стойчиты для этой группы о портрете Мехмеда II (1432–1481) < <http://www.nationalgallery.org.uk/paintings/attributed-to-gentile-bellini-the-sultan-mehmet-ii> работы Беллини, в которой он рассуждает о значении такого же пышного тюрбана султана.

At around the same time, the advent of printing and woodcut technology popularised a similar use of ‘coin-like’ images in other contexts, especially in illustrating histories. In these cases the portraits were often entirely drawn from the artist’s imagination or were loosely based on coinage, but presented their subject in a roundel with a legend or surrounding inscription. This image, for



Woodcut of emperors Leo III and Constantine V (though referred to as Constantius in the image), from the Hulton Archive/Getty Images.

example, depicts the Byzantine emperor Leo III (c. 685-741) and his son, Constantine (later the emperor Constantine V, 718-775), including an inscription which imitates though is not identical to those found on Byzantine coins.

The use of coin-like imagery and image framing seems to have lent these depictions a validity which simply a portrait on canvas in the case of John VIII, or an imagined likeness, as in the case of Leo III and Constantine, would not. By evoking coinage they seem to suggest the officially-regulated, 'live' portraiture on coins which in the pre-modern world might be the closest most people ever got to an image of their ruler, bringing the viewer closer to the subject, while simultaneously emphasising the status of that subject. What is particularly interesting about these examples, however, is that these emperors had coinage of their own: they were producing their own live portraits and presenting them to the world.



< <http://iconology.hypotheses.org/files/2015/02/Screenshot-2015-02-16-at-22.58.34.png>>

Silver half-hyperperon of John VIII Palaiologos. That is the emperor on the obverse (left). Honest! (Barber Institute of Fine Arts B6478).

In the case of John VIII, whose coinage reflects all too clearly the ongoing troubles of the Byzantine government and economy, it is perhaps easy to see why Pisanello's vision circulated better in the courts and fashionable circles of western Europe. Leo and Constantine's portrait (above), too, though more similar to their coinage, clearly suited the western Renaissance aesthetic better.



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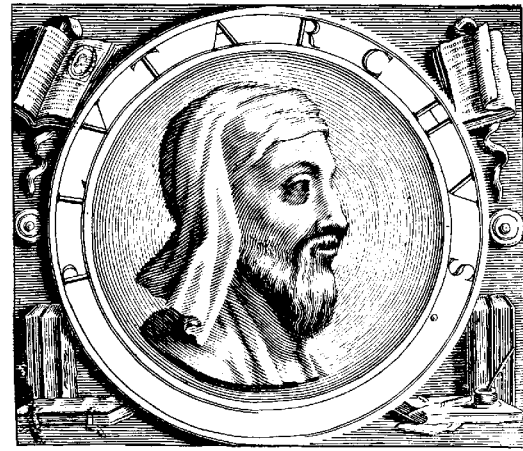
<http://iconology.hypotheses.org/files/2015/02/Screenshot-2015-02-16-at-23.04.11.png>>

Gold solidus of Leo III and Constantine V (Barber Institute of Fine Arts B4510).

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<http://iconology.hypotheses.org/files/2015/02/Plutarch.gif>> Without the tradition of coinage, which Byzantium, like western Europe, had inherited from the Roman

Empire these new depictions would not have resonated in the way that they did. Coins are not inevitably emblems of state power but in the Mediterranean tradition they could be nothing else. An interest in Roman coins paralleled an interest in Roman history, a re-use of



Ta sage instruction fert de riche couronne
A Trajan, esleuë par dessus tous humains.
Si les grands te porroient au cœur & dans leurs mains,
Vertu viuroit au lieu de Venus & Bellone

classical texts and objects that projected western Europe's burgeoning confidence, derived in large part from its growing wealth. However, rejection of the imagery of actual coinage in favour of a sterilised, beautified representation also reflected the recognition of a new economy of circulation in which woodcuts and medals were two forms of a newly-struck currency of images linking the educated elites of the west. Just as the Roman senatorial elite had in large part been bound by a shared participation in literary culture, the increasing accessibility of classical learning, as a result of book printing and the aspirations of the newly-prosperous to acquire the prestige of education required a new negotiation of cultural authority. Its clearest expression may be in the woodcut medal used to accompany an early French translation of Plutarch's *Parallel Lives*. The vernacular translation of a Greek text from the 1st/2nd century A.D., which brought together figures from the Hellenistic and Roman past to offer moral lessons on fame and virtue was illustrated with a fictional portrait of a man who had never appeared on coins – an authority

from the distant past circulating as a lesson on behaviour for a dynamic and confusing present.



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<http://barber.org.uk/inheriting-rome/>>

Inheriting Rome: the imperial legacy in coinage and culture (Barber Institute of Fine Arts, 27th February 2015-24th January 2016)

[visualising the divine on Byzantine and early Islamic coinage](#)) and showcases even more of the Barber's large and important collection of [Roman, Byzantine and eastern medieval coinage](#).

The continued use of coinage and the Roman past as an emblem of tradition, a source of authority and often a mask for change can be explored in more detail in the exhibition '[Inheriting Rome: the imperial legacy in coinage and culture](#)' <<http://barber.org.uk/inheriting-rome/>> opening at the [Barber Institute of Fine Arts](#) <

<http://barber.org.uk/>> in

Birmingham on 27th February (until January 2016). The exhibition replaces my curatorial debut at the Barber Institute

([Faith and Fortune:](#)

OpenEdition schlägt Ihnen vor, diesen Beitrag wie folgt zu zitieren:

Rebecca Darley (17. Februar 2015). Coining metaphors, continuing a conversation.

Bilderfahrzeuge. Abgerufen am 22. April 2026 von <https://doi.org/10.58079/psz2>

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